

INTERNATIONAL SPACE STATION

Space station

Orbiting 400 km (249 miles) above Earth's surface, the International Space Station (ISS) is the biggest man-made object in space. The individual modules were sent on American space shuttles or Russian Soyuz craft, and were assembled by space-walking astronauts. The crew conducts many experiments on board, including studying the effects of weightlessness on the human body over long periods, to prepare for manned trips to Mars.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 108.5 m (356 ft) long



FIRST MODULE LAUNCHED:
20 November 1998



MISSION DURATION: Ongoing



SPACE AGENCIES: NASA, ROSCOSMOS (Russia), JAXA (Japan), ESA, CSA (Canada)

European laboratory Columbus

Canadian robotic arm helps move equipment

Japanese science laboratory Kibo

American module Harmony has closets that work as bedrooms

The ISS has been **occupied continuously** since November 2000.